

$$a = 3.2 \times 10^{-10} \text{ m}$$

19

B

In order to hold the positively-charged particle P halfway between the two plates, the upper plate must be at a lower potential with respect to the lower plate (so that electric force acts upwards which is balanced by the gravitational force acting downwards).

By decreasing V and causing the positively-charged particle P to move towards the lower plate (which is at a higher potential), the EPE of the particle increases (since a positive charge's EPE increases with electric potential).

However, as the particle has fallen to a lower position, its GPE decreases.

20

C